RAYMOND HE

Department of Economics
University of Texas at Austin
4.118 BRB, 2225 Speedway
Austin, TX 78712, USA

raymondxuanhe.github.io
raymond.he@austin.utexas.edu
+1 512 576 8057
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Texas at Austin — 2021 – Present
Bachelor of Commerce (Honours in Economics), University of Melbourne — 2016 – 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International economics, labor economics, and computational economics

WORKING PAPERS

- "Everything In Moderation: The Currency-Maturity Composition of Sovereign Debt"
  Abstract: Emerging-market governments choose both the currency and maturity of their debt. I document a new fact: domestic-currency sovereign debt has systematically shorter maturity than foreign-currency debt. I develop a dynamic sovereign-debt model with endogenous default and inflation in which the government chooses among short- and long-term bonds denominated in domestic and foreign currency. Domestic-currency and long-term debt provide insurance against bad states but create inflation, default, and dilution incentives that lower their prices today. Foreign-currency and short-term debt provide stronger discipline but less insurance. When currency and maturity are chosen jointly, these forces make the extreme portfolios unattractive in normal states, leading governments to rely primarily on short-term domestic-currency and long-term foreign-currency debt. Calibrated to Türkiye, the model generates a domestic-to-foreign maturity ratio close to that observed in the data and shifts issuance toward short-term foreign-currency debt in adverse states.

- "How Much Can I Make? Cross-Firm Pay Transparency's Effects On the US Labor Market" - *with Suryansh Upmanyu* (Submitted)
  Abstract: Many major US jurisdictions have implemented pay transparency laws that require firms to advertise wage offers in vacancy postings. Using data on the near universe of job postings and representative survey data in a difference-in-differences framework, we find that these laws increased the fraction of postings with wage information by 24.7 percentage points. This translated to average real wage increases of 3.2%-4.4% in Colorado and 0.6%-1.3% in California and Washington. We further consistently find significant positive effects on real wages for workers who are male, have a college-degree, or are over forty years old.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- "Optimal Portfolio Uniqueness in Sovereign Debt Models" - *with Zachary Stangebye*
  Abstract: Governments often strategically alter what types of debt they issue in response to changing economic conditions. However, standard methods often struggle to accurately approximate portfolio policy functions. We document two numerical challenges when solving sovereign default models with portfolio choice: (i) irregular geometry due to regions that correspond to defaulting in equilibrium, and (ii) numerical indifference even in repayment regions. We show that the combination of Epstein–Zin preferences and sophisticated interpolation strategies, such as Adaptive Sparse Grids or Gaussian Process Regression, can overcome these difficulties.

POLICY WORK

- The duration and amplitude of Australia's housing cycles (with James Brugler and Maryam Nasiri), *Victoria's Economic Bulletin*. **4**: 1 - 13. February 2020. Lead article.

TEACHING ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

University of Texas at Austin	Intro to Labor Economics	Spring 2026, Fall 2026
	Macroeconomics I (Ph.D.)	Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025
	Science, Technology, & Politics	Spring 2025
	Introduction to Econometrics	Fall 2021, Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024
	International Trade and Investment	Summer 2023
	Introduction to Macroeconomics	Summer 2023
University of Melbourne	Econometrics 2	Spring 2019

AWARDS

- Summer Research Fellowship - University of Texas at Austin 2024, 2025, & 2026
- Professional Development Award - University of Texas at Austin 2023, 2024, & 2026
- Graduate Student Data Grant - University of Texas at Austin 2023
- Graduate Fellowship - University of Texas at Austin 2021 – 2026
- Brian Gray Scholarship - Australian Prudential Regulation Authority & Reserve Bank of Australia 2019
- Westpac Asian Exchange Scholarship - Westpac Bicentennial Foundation 2018
- Melbourne Global Scholars Award - University of Melbourne 2017

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (*SCHEDULED)

2026: Society for Computational Economics International Conference on Computing in Economics and Finance (Italy), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (USA)*

2025: Stata Texas Empirical Micro Conference (USA)

2024: Society for Computational Economics International Conference on Computing in Economics and Finance (Singapore)

2023: Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (USA), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (USA)

2020: Reserve Bank of Australia & Australian Prudential Regulation Authority (Australia)

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

- Economist - Department of Treasury & Finance Victoria 2020 – 2021
- Economics Intern - Department of Treasury & Finance Victoria 2018 – 2019

REFERENCES

Andrés Drenik
Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Texas at Austin
andres.drenik@austin.utexas.edu

Saroj Bhattarai
Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Texas at Austin
saroj.bhattarai@austin.utexas.edu

Oliver Pfäuti
Assistant Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Texas at Austin
oliver.pfauti@austin.utexas.edu

Zachary Stangebye
Associate Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
University of Notre Dame
zstangeb@nd.edu

OTHER INFORMATION

Citizenship: Australia. Currently on F1 visa; eligible to work in the U.S. via the E-3 visa.
Languages: English (Native), Chinese - Mandarin (Fluent)
Programming: Proficient in Julia, Experienced with R